



DOH59579

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

The Ohio Department of Health (ODH) is soliciting proposals for professional services.

1. **PROJECT INFORMATION:**

- 1.1. Project Title: Medical Specimen and Specimen Collection Supply Courier Services
- 1.2. Solicitation Posting Date: Thursday, February 12, 2026
- 1.3. Inquiry Start Date: Thursday, February 12, 2026
- 1.4. Inquiry End Date: Thursday, February 26, 2026, by 3 p.m. All questions must be submitted via Ohio Buys. Questions received after this date will not receive a response.
- 1.5. Solicitation End Date: Thursday, March 5, 2026 by 3 p.m. All required application components must be received by Thursday, March 5, 2026 at 3 p.m. Applications should be submitted via Ohio Buys. Each application component must be clearly labeled.
- 1.6. Project Background: The Ohio Department of Health Bureau of Public Health Laboratory (BPHL) assist with disease diagnosis, environmental surveillance, and epidemiological support by processing/testing specimen samples for local public health jurisdictions, clinics, hospitals, and other state agencies. Tests performed on specimen samples can be time and temperature sensitive and require a scheduled delivery time frame.
- 1.7. Project Objective: The objective is to provide courier service for transporting time sensitive specimen samples for testing to the Ohio Department of Health Bureau of Public Health Laboratory (BPHL).
- 1.8. Projected Estimated Budget: Not to Exceed \$70,000 per State Fiscal Year (SFY)
- 1.9. Project Award: One (1) Award.
- 1.10. Project Period: 4/1/2026 – 6/30/2027.

ODH reserves the right to execute multiple agreements with awarded provider to fulfill the entire project period, subject to and contingent on the discretionary decision of the Ohio General Assembly to appropriate funds (if needed) for the biennium, satisfactory performance of the awarded providers and the needs of the Ohio Department of Health.
- 1.11. Agreement Term: 4/1/2026 - 6/30/2027 with up to four (4) years of additional Renewal Terms may not exceed after 6/30/2031.
- 1.12. Renewal Terms: 48-months optional renewal period(s) dependent upon the receipt and approval of funds to ODH for this project, this agreement may be renewed into two (2) 24-month terms.



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- Renewal Optional Period 1: 7/1/2027 - 6/30/2029
- Renewal Optional Year 2: 7/1/2029 - 6/30/2031

At the sole option of ODH, ODH may extend this Contract past the initial Agreement Term for a period of ninety (90) days. Renewal terms may be exercised by mutual agreement between the Contractor and ODH. The cumulative time of all mutual renewals may not exceed four (4) additional years and are subject to and are contingent upon the discretionary decision of the Ohio General Assembly to appropriate funds for this project in each new biennium. If any renewal is exercised, a new contract will be issued at the beginning of the new biennium. ODH may evaluate whether a renewal is appropriate considering the satisfactory performance of the Contractor and the future and continuing needs of ODH's Programs.

2. PROJECT REQUIREMENTS: Offeror(s) must meet the following mandatory requirements to be considered for evaluation.

2.1. Preferred Contractor Experience Requirement:

- 2.1.1. Offeror must have minimum three (3) years of experience in medical specimen courier services.
- 2.1.2. Offeror must have the capacity to pick up specimens from submitters across the State of Ohio and deliver the specimens to BPHL or pick up mosquito specimen collection supplies from BPHL and deliver the supplies to Health Departments throughout the State of Ohio. The mosquito specimen collection supplies consist of Styrofoam coolers inside cardboard shipping boxes containing thawed ice packs, empty plastic bags, and empty sample tubes.
- 2.1.3. Offeror must have the capability to ship clinical specimens, to protect them from degradation, including protection from exposure to heat and humidity.
- 2.1.4. Offeror must have a tracking system which monitors the status of pick-ups and deliveries.

2.2. Preferred Candidate Expertise Requirement:

- 2.2.1. Offeror must have a valid Driver's License
- 2.2.2. Offeror must have completed training for Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) sample transportation that includes Rabies, Microbiology, Tuberculosis and Mosquito specimens.

2.3. Notice of Award Requirements: N/A



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2.4. Mandatory Licenses &/or Certifications Required:

- 2.4.1. Offeror must have the active required licenses, bonds, facilities, equipment and trained personnel necessary to perform the work.

3. **SCOPE OF WORK AND DELIVERABLES:**

3.1. Scope of Work:

SCOPE OF WORK	
3.1.1	<u>General Requirements:</u> 1. Pick up specimen samples from local public health jurisdictions, clinics, hospitals, and other state agencies located throughout the 88 counties in Ohio up to five (5) days a week Sunday through Thursday and deliver up to five (5) days a week to the Ohio Department of Health Bureau of Public Health Laboratory (BPHL), Monday through Friday, at a time mutually agreed upon between the courier service and all pick up locations unless instructed otherwise. Occasionally, pick up mosquito specimens from Health Departments throughout the State of Ohio and deliver the mosquito specimens to BPHL. Occasionally, pick up mosquito specimen collection supplies from BPHL and deliver the supplies to Health Departments throughout the State of Ohio. 2. Pack and ship all specimen samples in accordance with the U.S. Department of Transportation's Hazardous Materials Regulations (DOT 49 CFR Parts 171-180), with the International Air Transport Association's Dangerous Goods Regulations (IATA) and as identified below in the storage and handling of medical specimen samples section. 3. Protect specimen samples from heat in summer months. Heat will cause a deterioration of the enzyme activities in specimens. 4. Ensure that specimen samples are not exposed to weather conditions exceeding 90 degrees Fahrenheit. 5. Deliver each specimen sample in the same condition and temperature as it was when picked up, with no variances during transit. 6. Specimen samples must be kept dry. 7. Specimen samples cannot be put through conveyor systems which could result in damage and/or loss. 8. Provide on-time deliveries. Notification of not making the delivery on time is to be communicated prior to the delivery time. 9. Deliver specimen samples to the BPHL, Monday-Friday from 7:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. 10. Deliver specimen samples and supplies on demand when requested, and on weekends or holidays when requested. 11. There can be no delay in receipt. Same-day or next-day delivery is required. 12. Provide access to a tracking/monitoring system in order to review. 13. Track/monitor/manage pick-up and delivery of specimen samples and supplies.



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	14. Notify BPHL of any specimen samples that were in the contractor's possession longer than 24 hours and document in the weekly report the explanation for the delay in shipping.
3.1.2	<u>Customer Service:</u> 1. For account representatives assigned to BPHL - A telephone number and/or e-mail address must be available 24 hours a day, Monday through Saturday, for discussing problems or answering questions. Account representatives must be knowledgeable about the BPHL account and be available to answer questions on a regular basis. 2. The Contractor must provide web access tracking with BPHL having access. 3. The Contractor must be able to provide delivery confirmation. 4. The Contractor must provide with its Bid, Descriptive Literature that describes its tracking capability.
3.1.3	<u>Training:</u> 1. The Contractor must provide training for Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) blood-borne pathogen (BBP) trainings for drivers upon hire and thereafter. 2. This training is to be paid for by the Contractor. The training should include: a. Specimen transportation including identifying risks associated with transporting medical specimens b. Measures to prevent exposure c. Proper labeling d. Spill clean-up: Using biohazard clean up procedures e. Specimen integrity f. HIPAA compliance g. Administrative requirements (e.g., OSHA compliant records) h. Definitions/language commonly used by clinical laboratory personnel to better understand their needs and expectations
3.1.4	<u>Delivery and Pickup Requirements:</u> All shipments of specimen <u>samples</u> are to be delivered to: Ohio Department of Health Bureau of Public Health Laboratory



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	8995 East Main Street, Building 22 Reynoldsburg, OH 43068 Hours of Operation: 7:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m., Monday - Friday Telephone number: (614) 715-6557 for BPHL deliveries between 7:00 a.m. – 4:00 p.m.; and (614) 715-7297 for BPHL deliveries from between 4:00 p.m. – 5:00 p.m. All shipments of mosquito specimen collection supplies are to be picked up <u>from</u>: 8995 East Main Street, Building 22 Reynoldsburg, OH 43068 and delivered <u>to</u>: Health Departments throughout the State of Ohio, as labeled. <u>Note:</u> 1. No delivery is expected when a Level 3 snow emergency is declared in Franklin or Licking Counties or if a Level 3 snow emergency is declared in a County that would be a direct route to/from Franklin or Licking Counties. 2. No pick-up is expected if a Level 3 snow emergency is declared in the County of the pickup location. 3. Pick-ups are Monday through Thursday from 7:00 a.m. - 5:00 p.m. Deliveries to the BPHL are Monday through Friday from 7:00 a.m. - 5:00 p.m. 4. Major holidays are exempt from pick-ups and deliveries. 5. Mosquito specimen delivery to BPHL or mosquito specimen collection supplies delivery to Health Departments throughout the State of Ohio will be on an occasional basis only.
3.1.5	<u>Storage and Handling of Medical Specimen Samples:</u> 1. The Contractor must store medical specimen samples that cannot be delivered due to Level 3 snow emergencies and must deliver at 7:00 a.m. the next available day the BPHL opens after the snow emergency is cancelled. 2. The Contractor must never leave a shipment at the BPHL unattended. If BPHL personnel are not available to receive shipments, the Contractor must store shipments and redeliver at 7:00 a.m. the next day the BPHL opens. 3. Rabies Specimens - Handling and packaging animal heads or brain tissue should be kept refrigerated but not frozen. The specimen should be double bagged using heavy plastic and each bag should be properly sealed. Do not use metal twist ties. If the



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	specimen has any sharp protruding parts such as shattered bone, wrap it in several layers of newspaper first. Place the bagged specimen in an insulated container and surround the specimen with frozen packs. If dry ice must be used, place aluminum foil or several layers of newspaper between it and the specimen to prevent freezing. If more than one animal of the same species is submitted in a container, each head should be bagged and tagged separately for identification. Seal container securely with tape. A fully completed eLIMS requisition form must be included for each specimen submitted. If the form is submitted within the shipping container, be sure it is sealed in a separate waterproof bag in the event of leakage. If necessary, securely affix it in an envelope to the outside of the container. Shipping specimens should be either hand delivered or sent by overnight courier service. Do not ship on Fridays or before holidays as there may be no one at the lab to accept delivery on weekends. Instead, hold the specimen until the following weekday. 4. Tuberculosis (TB) Clinical specimens - Shipping specimen refrigerated on cold packs is preferred, otherwise, ship overnight at ambient temperature. Stability - Ambient: 24 hours; refrigerated: 1 week, if courier has longer than 24 hours, they must refrigerate. Do not ship on Fridays or before holidays as there may be no one at the lab to accept delivery on weekends. Instead, hold the specimen until the following weekday. 5. Microbiology specimens - Ship overnight at refrigerated temperature on cold packs or, if frozen, on dry ice. Stability – refrigerated: three days; frozen at minus 70 C (minus 94 F): indefinite. Do not ship on Fridays or before holidays as there may be no one at the lab to accept delivery on weekends. Instead, hold the specimen until the following weekday. 6. Mosquito specimens - Mosquitoes are to be stored frozen until ready to be shipped. Whole mosquitoes will be placed in 5-mL polypropylene tubes labeled with the agency number, location number, collection date, and trap type. All tubes of mosquitoes that were collected on the same day should be put into the same small, zippered plastic bag with the date written on the bag in permanent marker. Put all small plastic bags together into one gallon-size zippered plastic bag. A printed copy of the field collection record should be included with the samples, sealed inside a separate plastic bag to protect it from moisture. Place the bagged tubes in an insulated container and surround the samples with multiple frozen ice packs. The insulated container must be shipped inside a cardboard box, fully taped shut with the agency number written on the side. Shipping containers may remain at room temperature during transit, however extreme heat should be avoided. To ensure overnight delivery, do not ship samples on Fridays or on the day before a holiday.
3.1.6	<u>Damages/Claims:</u>



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	1. The Contractor must document and report damaged specimens within 24 hours of the incident. 2. If the Contractor damages a Rabies, Microbiology, Tuberculosis and/or Mosquito sample, the courier service will be responsible for shipping fees incurred to resend the sample. The courier will be responsible for laboratory fees incurred to recreate the specimen. 3. The Contractor must acknowledge that damages that pose a risk of exposure would include a package being torn open. Proper handling of the sealed packages should prevent any instances of exposure.
3.1.7	<u>Packaging/Labeling:</u> 1. Hospitals, clinics, and physician offices are responsible for packaging Rabies, Microbiology, Tuberculosis and/or Mosquito specimens in the correct packaging for shipping the specific type of specimen. 2. Packaging details for each specimen type are listed in the Storage and Handling of Medical Specimen Samples section of this document. 3. The Contractor is responsible for creating shipping labels for hospitals, clinics, and physician offices with unique barcodes for tracking purposes. Information to include on the label: shipper facility name and a unique barcode for tracking samples during shipping. 4. Hospitals, clinics, and physician offices shall apply the biohazard labels and shipping label on every shipment.
3.1.8	<u>Subcontractor(s):</u> 1. All parties using this Contract (ODH, Hospitals, Clinics, etc.) will only interact with the Primary Contractor on every matter concerning this Contract.
3.1.9	<u>Billing/Invoices:</u> 1. The Contractor can only charge the ODH per shipment and pick up fees as agreed upon in this Contract. Contractor's proposal may include additional, separate fees for after hours, weekend and non-major holidays (if applicable). Additional proposed fees will be reviewed for consideration and subject to negotiation by ODH. Any other charges will not be honored under this agreement. Invoices are to be sent to: Ohio Department of Health (ODH) P.O. Box 118 Columbus, OH 43216-0118



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3.2. Deliverables and Due Dates:

DELIVERABLES		DUE DATE
3.2.1	Provide medical specimen courier services to pick up specimen samples from hospitals, physicians' offices, and clinics located throughout the 88 counties in Ohio and deliver the samples to the Ohio Department of Health Bureau of Public Health Laboratory (BPHL) located in Reynoldsburg, Ohio. Provide courier services to pick up mosquito specimen collection supplies from BPHL and deliver the supplies to Health Departments throughout the State of Ohio. The mosquito specimen collection supplies consist of Styrofoam coolers inside cardboard shipping boxes containing thawed ice packs, empty plastic bags, and empty sample tubes.	Throughout the Contract Term
3.2.2	Provide Weekly Reporting that includes trip details to include the service date, route number, lab name, customer name, number of deliveries, number of pick-ups, number of trips, cost per trip, subtotal, and type of delivery (i.e., type of specimen and/or supplies).	Weekly Throughout the Contract Term
3.2.3	Provide Quarterly Reporting that includes trip details to include the service date, route number, lab name, customer name, number of deliveries, number of pick-ups, number of trips, cost per trip, subtotal, and type of delivery (i.e., type of specimen and/or supplies).	Quarterly Throughout the Contract Term
3.2.4	Provide Tracking of Pick-ups/Deliveries.	Throughout the Contract Term
3.2.5	Provide shipping labels for hospitals, clinics, and physician offices with unique barcodes for tracking purposes.	Throughout the Contract Term

4. TECHNICAL EVALUATION CRITERION:

CONTRACTOR PROFILE		WEIGHT
4.1	Offeror's proposal needs to describe services your organization has provided in the past three (3) years that demonstrate your organization's capability to perform the services described in this bid.	30
4.2	Offeror's proposal documented the ability to have a HIPPA Agreement in place or upon contract award.	10

STAFFING PLAN (PERSONNEL PROFILE)	WEIGHT
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4.3	Offeror's proposal provided documentation that all courier staff have a valid driver's license.	10
4.4	Offeror's proposal documented that all staff would complete/or have completed training for Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) sample transportation that include Rabies, Microbiology, Tuberculosis and Mosquito specimens.	10

WORK PLAN		WEIGHT
4.5	Offeror's proposal described capacity, approach, methods, and specific work steps to monitor, track and update schedules for any pickup and deliveries. Including the type of scheduling system/software and the number of employees who are well-versed in using that system/software	20
4.6	Offeror's proposal provided evidence of experience in providing monitoring/tracking of pick-up and delivery projects, and other information regarding scheduling ability.	20

TOTAL	100
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5. PROPOSAL SCORING

CRITERIA	MAXIMUM ALLOWABLE POINTS
Technical Proposal	500
Cost Proposal	200
MBE Set -Aside	50
Total	750